SOP-029: In-App Browser and Mobile Checkout Testing Without Real Orders

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Scope: Echelon storefront checkout on phones, including social app browsers
Status: Approved test procedure

Purpose

Social traffic converts worst at checkout, and most of it opens inside the Instagram, Facebook or Snapchat in-app browser. This SOP describes how to test the full mobile checkout in those browsers without placing a real order or spending money.

Rules

- Never place a real order to test. Stop at the last step before payment is captured.
- Use a test shipping address, not a customer's.
- Do not cancel or edit real orders to work around a test.

Getting into the in-app browser

1. Send yourself the product URL in Instagram, Facebook Messenger or Snapchat, or tap a live ad.
2. Open the link inside the app. Do not choose "Open in browser".
3. Confirm you are in the in-app browser: the app's own toolbar shows at the top.

Test matrix

Run each row on a real phone, in each in-app browser and in Safari or Chrome as a control:

Step	Pass condition
PDP	Title, price and monthly price visible; Add to cart works
Cart	Chat bubble does not cover buttons; no game popup once the cart has items; Check out visible
Checkout information	Address autocomplete works; shipping rates load
Shop Pay	Opens and can be closed
PayPal	Opens, and the shopper can return to checkout
Apple Pay / Google Pay	Payment sheet opens; cancel before authorizing

Step	Pass condition
Financing (ChargeAfter)	Window opens without warnings; lenders are selectable; load time noted

Recording results

- Take screenshots of each failure with the time and app version.
- Note whether the issue comes from the theme (fixable by us) or a vendor window (send to the vendor through the account owner).
- Cross-check analytics: compare checkout-to-cart rates by channel in Shopify, since pixel-based tools can under-report checkouts.

Known vendor finding

As of October 28, 2026 the ChargeAfter window shows an "Update Your Browser" banner inside in-app browsers. This is vendor side and has been escalated.